



SESSION 2 — MENTOR GUIDE

My Story

You are the witness of a story the athlete may have never heard themselves tell. Keep the space sacred.

SESSION GOAL

Help the athlete know and appreciate their personal story. Narrative identity is the foundation of resilience.

CONVERSATION FLOW

OPENING (5 MIN)

""Tell me — how did you actually get into this sport? Who had an influence?""

💡 Let the story come organically. Don't interrupt.

EXPLORING (15 MIN)

""Which moment on your timeline moves you most when you look at it now?""

💡 Emotion is welcome. Normalize it: "It's okay if something feels." Don't solve, just be present.

DEEPENING (10 MIN)

""Who was the most influential person in your athletic career? What did they do that made a difference?""

💡 This gives you as mentor insight into what the athlete needs from a mentoring relationship.

CLOSING (5 MIN)

""If your story had a title — what would it be?""

💡 A powerful closer that helps the athlete own their story.

OBSERVE

- Which episodes does the athlete avoid — did they skip over something quickly?
- Which people do they mention — and with what emotion?
- Is there a pattern in the turning points? (E.g., always external factors, or always personal choices)
- How does the athlete talk about their lowest point? Shame? Pride in surviving? Still painful?

△ NOTE

Difficult stories may come up: injuries, loss, bullying, failure. You don't need to solve that. Use: "Thank you for sharing that. That sounds like it was hard." Then continue.

CLOSING

Reflect the pattern you heard: "What strikes me in your story is..." Link this to the next session on goals: "What does your past tell you about what you want for the future?"

MENTOR NOTES